
Recovery After 40

Companion Workbook — build your post-40
sustainable practice

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

Recovery After 40

Companion Workbook — build your
post-40 sustainable practice

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

HEALING HANDS BY NATE

Recovery After 40

© 2026 Healing Hands By Nate. All rights reserved.

Nate Ratcliff, LMT

Inner Circle Deep Cut — #6 Workbook

For Healing Hands By Nate Inner Circle members. Personal use only. Please don't redistribute — share the membership instead.

Published by Healing Hands By Nate

Contents

1. How to use this workbook
2. Where You Are Today — Post-40 Baseline
3. Reflection Prompts
4. Building Your 15-Minute Daily Practice
5. 30-Day Daily Practice Tracker
6. 30-Day Reflection
7. Quarterly Check-Ins
8. Annual Health Maintenance Checklist
9. Year-End Reflection
10. Try this for 30 days

Introduction

A YEAR-LONG COMPANION TO THE IC6 DEEP CUT.
Build your post-40 sustainable practice.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

YEAR-LONG REFERENCE. SELF-ASSESSMENT first to baseline where you are. Then the daily practice tracker. Then quarterly check-ins.

Bring it to every session.

CHAPTER 2

Where You Are Today — Post-40 Baseline

AGE: _ / SEX: / GENERAL HEALTH STATUS:

Aging vs Deconditioning Self-Assessment

For each symptom, mark whether you've been blaming it on age OR addressing it actively.

Symptom (Y/N)	Actively addressing (Y/N)	Blame age
Morning stiffness		
[____]	[____]	
Slower recovery from activity		
[____]	[____]	
Reduced energy		
[____]	[____]	
"Stiff" feeling all the time		
[____]	[____]	
Less mobile than I used to be		
[____]	[____]	
Easier injuries		
[____]	[____]	
Sleep quality declining		
[____]	[____]	
Joint complaints		
[____]	[____]	

Honest reflection: How many of the things I’m blaming on age might actually be deconditioning?

Current Activity Inventory

Resistance training: _ days/week, __ minutes per session

Cardio: _____ minutes total per week

Daily stretching/mobility: _____ minutes per day

Balance work: ☐ Yes, regularly / ☐ Sometimes /
☐ No

Walking: _____ minutes total per week (separate
from cardio)

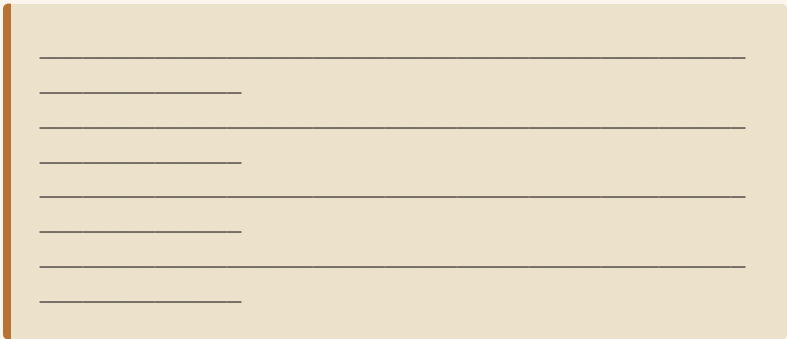
Sleep: _____ hours average per night

**Compared to recommended minimum effective
dose:** ☐ Above / ☐ At / ☐ Below

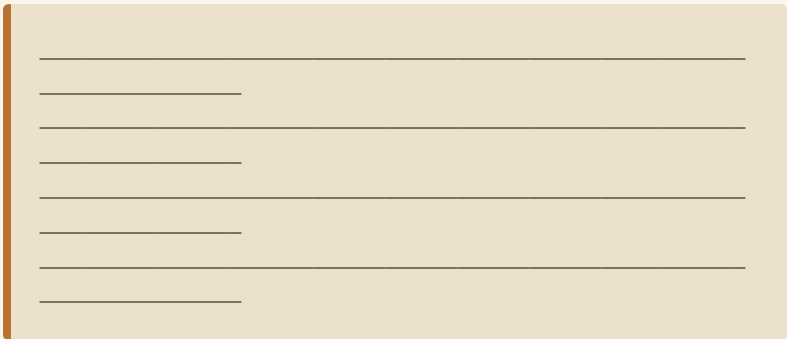
CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

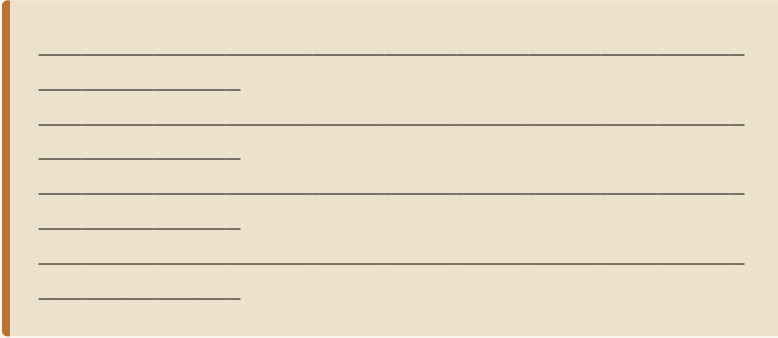
PROMPT 1: WHAT’S ONE THING YOU’VE STOPPED doing because you “got older” — but might actually still be able to do with the right approach?



Prompt 2: Think of someone you know (or know of) who’s functioning impressively well at 60, 70, or 80. What patterns do you notice about how they take care of themselves?



Prompt 3: What's your honest fear about your own aging? And what's one small action you could take this week that would address it?



A light beige rectangular box with a vertical brown line on the left side, containing eight horizontal lines for writing.



A single horizontal line for writing.

CHAPTER 4

Building Your 15-Minute Daily Practice

MY FIXED TIME: ____

My fixed place: ____

Tools needed (and where they live):

My 15-Minute Routine

Minute 1-5 (mobility):

1.

2.

3.

Minute 6-10 (balance + strengthening OR breathing):

1.

2.

3.

Minute 11-15 (movement OR foam rolling OR wind-down):

1.

2.

3.

CHAPTER 5

30-Day Daily Practice Tracker

DAY	DATE	DONE?	FELT HOW (1-10)	NOTES
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17				
18				

DAY	DATE	DONE?	FELT HOW (1-10)	NOTES
19				
20				
21				
22				
23				
24				
25				
26				
27				
28				
29				
30				

CHAPTER 6

30-Day Reflection

DAYS COMPLETED: ____ OF 30

Average “felt how” rating: ____

Things that got easier in 30 days:

Things that didn’t change (and that’s okay):

What I’ll commit to for the next 30 days:

CHAPTER 7

Quarterly Check-Ins

Q1 Check-In

DATE: ____

Daily practice consistency over past 90 days: []

Almost every day / [] Most days / [] Inconsistent

Functional improvements I've noticed:

Recovery time changes I've noticed (better/same/worse):

Adjustments for next quarter:

Q2 Check-In

Date: ____

Daily practice consistency: [☐] Daily / [☐] Most / [☐]
Inconsistent

Functional changes:

Adjustments:

Q3 Check-In

Date: ____

Daily practice consistency: [☐] Daily / [☐] Most / [☐]
Inconsistent

Functional changes:

Adjustments:

Q4 Check-In

Date: __

Daily practice consistency: [] Daily / [] Most / [] Inconsistent

Functional changes:

Adjustments:

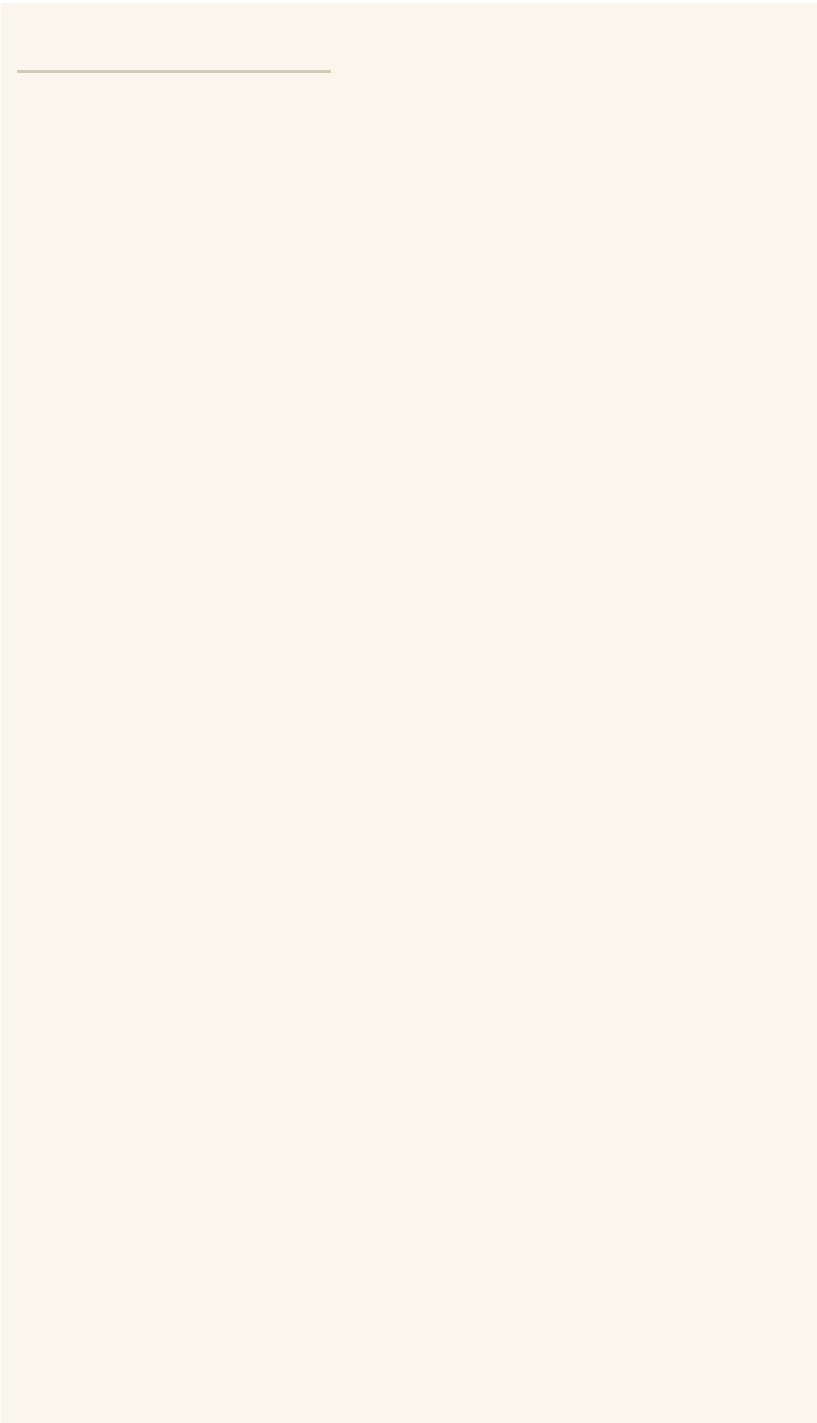
CHAPTER 8

Annual Health Maintenance Checklist

AFTER 40, RECOMMENDED:

- [] Annual physical with bloodwork (this year: __)
- [] Vision exam every 2 years (last: __, **next:** __)
- [] Dental cleaning every 6 months (last: __, **next:** __)
- [] Skin check (last: __, **next:** __)
- [] Bone density baseline (50 women / 65 men) — done: [Y / N / Scheduled]
- [] Colonoscopy starting at 45 — done: [Y / N / Scheduled]
- [] Mammogram (women) at recommended interval — done: [Y / N / Scheduled]
- [] PSA screening (men) per physician — done: [Y / N / Scheduled]
- [] Cardiovascular assessment if family history or symptoms

Your medical maintenance is part of your overall recovery practice. Don't skip it.



CHAPTER 9

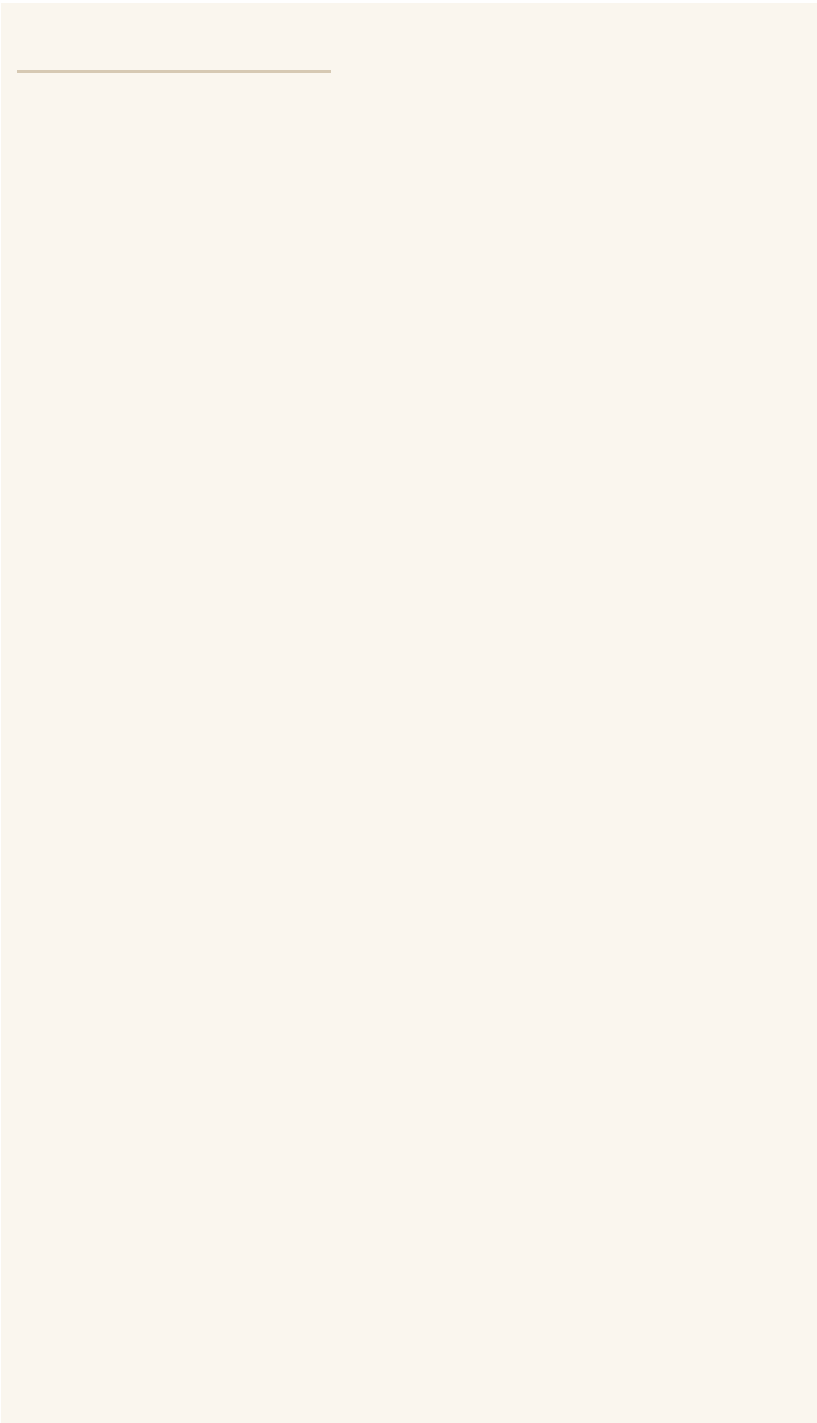
Year-End Reflection

COMPARED TO ONE YEAR AGO, MY BODY IS: []
Significantly better / [] Somewhat better / []
Same / [] Somewhat worse / [] Significantly
worse

The single biggest improvement:

What I'm proud of accomplishing:

One commitment for the year ahead:



CHAPTER 10

Try this for 30 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK,
try this:

A 15-minute daily practice. Same time. Same place. Every day for 30 days.

That's the foundational ask. 15 minutes. Daily. Non-negotiable.

Most people in their 40s, 50s, 60s who actually do this for 30 days are stunned by the difference. The body responds to consistent attention at any age.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
LMT and published by Healing Hands By
Nate.